

News Weekly

Tropical Storm Bertha moves toward Texas landfall after grazing Louisiana's coast

Tropical Storm Bertha impacted Louisiana, southwest of New Orleans, early Thursday morning, and was heading west towards Texas. Initially, it struck St. Bernard Parish, approximately 40 miles east of New Orleans, on Wednesday afternoon. Bertha was projected to reach the upper Texas coast by Thursday and dissipate inland by Friday.

By early Thursday, the storm was located 110 miles southwest of New Orleans and 120 miles southeast of Lake Charles, Louisiana, with a movement speed of 12 mph and winds measuring 45 mph. The National Hurricane Center identified wind and storm surge as the primary threats. A tropical storm warning extended from Alabama to Louisiana, including New Orleans, where the situation was exacerbated by extreme heat.

Even with the storm, heavy rains remained offshore, lowering flood risks. Residents observed the storm surge at Lake Pontchartrain while children played in the floodwaters. (NBC)



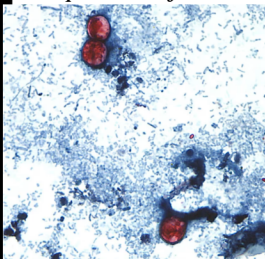
Orcas filmed smashing giant sunfish into thousands of pieces

Orcas are renowned for their intelligence and varied hunting strategies. Recently, researchers in the Gulf of California documented a previously unobserved behavior among orcas. Dr. Kathryn Ayres from *Beneath The Waves* reported in *"Frontiers in Ethology"* that orcas engage in a unique technique to dismember sunfish. In this behavior, one orca captures a sunfish and releases it just before another orca collides with it at high speed, effectively breaking it into pieces. This behavior may facilitate easier feeding for younger orcas or could potentially serve as a form of play. Sunfish, which can exceed three meters in length and weigh up to 2,000 kg, often rise to the surface, rendering them particularly vulnerable. This remarkable behavior was recorded during two separate events, occurring a year apart. (Science News)



Massive cyclosporiasis outbreak linked to four more states

Nine states are now grappling with diarrheal illness cases linked to the microscopic cyclospora parasite, as reported by an unnamed CDC official. Illinois, Kansas, Oklahoma, and Pennsylvania have recently joined the outbreak list, which already included Indiana, Kentucky, Michigan, Ohio, and West Virginia. Federal and state health officials are conducting an investigation, with the additional states first reported by the Washington Post. Over 12,000 cyclosporiasis cases have emerged this summer, predominantly in Michigan. If linked, this could become one of the largest foodborne illness outbreaks in the U.S. in thirty years. Interviews point to iceberg lettuce from Central Mexico as the likely source. Taylor Farms has recalled shredded lettuce distributed to 27 states. The FDA and Mexican health authorities are investigating the contamination cause. The CDC is also examining multiple clusters of cases, which may not all share the same source. (CNN)



Michelin-starred chef facing jail after allegedly serving nearly 50,000 ants to diners

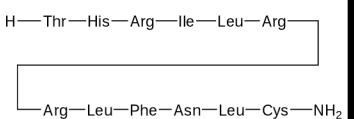
In a culinary plot twist worthy of a cooking show drama, the owner of a Michelin-starred restaurant in South Korea is stirring up more than just sorbets. This time, it's trouble, potentially leading to a year behind bars and a \$13,510 fine for allegedly sprinkling ants on desserts! While South Korea's Food Sanitation Act rolls out the red carpet for 10 insect species, ants didn't make the guest list. The ant-ics came to light thanks to social media sleuths and online reviews buzzing about the tiny critters. Prosecutors waved a red flag, claiming these uninvited guests packed heavy metals 55 times over the legal limit. However, the defense is raising their spoons, saying ants were merely an optional flourish and a choice of 60% of adventurous diners. Grab your popcorn; the verdict is set for September! (FOX)



AI helps Stanford scientists discover "natural Ozempic" without the usual side effects

Researchers at Stanford Medicine have identified a novel molecule known as BRP, which has the potential to suppress appetite and facilitate weight loss in a manner comparable to semaglutide, the active component in Ozempic. Notably, BRP may circumvent common side effects such as nausea and muscle loss. This molecule functions through a distinct metabolic pathway, stimulating neurons in the hypothalamus, the region responsible for regulating appetite and metabolism. This specificity could make BRP a more effective tool for weight management without impacting other bodily systems.

The discovery of BRP was significantly aided by artificial intelligence, particularly through an algorithm named Peptide Predictor. This program analyzed 20,000 human genes to identify proteins susceptible to cleavage by prohormone convertase 1/3, an enzyme associated with obesity. From an initial pool of 373 identified prohormones, the Peptide Predictor estimated 2,683 potential peptides. Researchers then concentrated on 100 of these peptides, evaluating their effects on neuronal cells. Among them, BRP exhibited a marked increase in neuronal activity and, when tested on lean mice and minipigs, resulted in a reduction of food intake by as much as 50%, with treated obese mice demonstrating significant fat loss. (Science Daily)



Jokes

Why did 6 not camp with 7?

Because 7 had knives for sur5al but 789.

Ptable



Magic Sum = 48

	16	

Moroccan seasoned chicken

- Marinate the Chicken
 - Pat chicken dry for better spice adherence.
 - Blend spices and rub onto chicken evenly.
 - Add olive oil, massaging it in.
 - Marinate at room temperature for 15–20 minutes or refrigerate for 2 hours.
 - Sear the Chicken
- Heat olive oil in a large skillet over medium-high heat.
- Sear chicken 4–5 minutes per side until golden.
 - Prepare the Sauce
 - Sauté onions until softened.
 - Add garlic, lemon juice, chicken broth.
 - Simmer for 2–3 minutes.
 - Cook Chicken Through
 - Return chicken to the pan.
 - Cover, cook until internal temperature is reached.
 - Serve
 - Garnish with cilantro.
 - Serve with couscous.
- Moroccan Spice Blend**
- 1 tsp paprika
 - 1 tsp ground cumin
 - 1 tsp ground coriander
 - ½ tsp ground cinnamon
 - ½ tsp turmeric
 - ¼ tsp cayenne pepper (adjust to taste)
 - ½ tsp ground ginger
 - ½ tsp ground cloves (optional)
 - 1 tsp salt
 - Black pepper to taste
 - Optional: Ras El Hanout for more traditional flavor
- Chicken and Additional Ingredients**
- 4–6 bone-in chicken thighs or 4 large chicken breasts
 - 2 tbsp olive oil (plus extra if needed)
 - 1 medium onion, sliced or chopped
 - 3–4 cloves garlic, minced
 - 1 lemon (zested and juiced)
 - 1–2 cups chicken broth

